OPERATIONS WORKBOOK

Final-Loop Rehearsal and Interview-Day Runbook

A compressed multi-round rehearsal, transition protocol, evidence debrief, taper plan, and printable day-of operating sheet.

Consolidate proven skills, protect recovery between rounds, and remove avoidable interview-day friction.

VERSION 1.1

FORMAT GUIDE + WORKED EXAMPLES

STATUS LEARNER READY

OPERATIONS / FINAL-LOOP-INTERVIEW-DAY-RUNBOOK

CONSOLIDATE, THEN REDUCE FRICTION

Use the final loop to protect proven skills

The capstone combines a compressed multi-round rehearsal with a one-page operating runbook. It is a practice sequence, not a prediction of a company's exact interview loop.

CORE IDEA

Week 12 is a taper. Use representative prompts, protect transitions, prove recovery, and remove day-of uncertainty. Do not add a new syllabus or chase a perfect score.

01	02	03	04
Assemble	**Rehearse**	**Debrief**	**Operate**
Select one coding, design, behavioral, and follow-up segment from existing preparation.	Run the 60-minute sequence and reset deliberately between segments.	Record three stable strengths, one remaining risk, and one final action.	Build the 15-minute day-of runbook from the rehearsal evidence.

REHEARSAL

60 minutes

A compressed full-loop rehearsal that tests retrieval, transitions, recovery, and a focused close.

RUNBOOK

15 minutes

A one-page logistics and cognitive-load runbook that supports the real interview day.

Boundaries

- [ ] Use only prompts, stories, and frameworks already prepared.
- [ ] Use mini-prompts that fit the compressed segment windows.
- [ ] Do not record confidential prompts or another person without permission.
- [ ] The runbook lowers cognitive load; it is not a binder to read during answers.

WORKED LOOP PLAN

Choose four segments with observable stopping points

This illustrative plan fits the existing 60-minute clock. Select your own fresh, authorized prompts and truthful story; keep the capability, evidence cue, and stop condition explicit.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Segment	Capability	Prompt / source	Evidence cue	Time / stop
Coding	Invariant plus boundary test	Own fresh mini-prompt: maximum unique-character substring length.	Say no-repeat invariant before code; trace abba without moving left backward.	18 min; approach, implementation, boundary, complexity.
System design	Requirement-led reliability trade-off	Mini-design: accept and deliver a notification when provider is slow.	State acceptance and retry guarantee before queue; explain one timeout timeline.	18 min; main flow, one failure, metric, trade-off.
Behavioral	Owned judgment under pressure	Own incident story: rollback versus hotfix, using only recorded facts.	Name personal decision, rejected alternative, result, and prevention.	10 min; story plus one evidence probe.
Follow-up pivot	Adapt without contradicting contract	Change notification request: one tenant now creates half of all work.	Update fairness and admission limits; retain unrelated event semantics.	6 min; affected decision and one cost.

Selection rules

+ Coding: use a prompt that requires a visible invariant or boundary decision.
+ Design: use a prompt with one meaningful capacity or failure trade-off.
+ Behavioral: use a story with ownership, tension, action, and measurable result.
+ Follow-up: change one requirement or ask for one deeper evidence layer.
+ Corrected gap: name the segment and exact cue where the new behavior must appear.

SOURCE RULE

Select from active Library mocks and your own evidence map. Do not use leaked company questions, confidential material, or a prompt you can answer from memory.

THE 60-MINUTE CLOCK

Protect transitions as part of the answer

A full loop is more than four prompts. It tests whether the learner can release one context, establish the next contract, and recover without carrying forward stale assumptions.

Clock	Segment	Protected behavior
0-2	Setup	Confirm prompts, assistance policy, timer, evidence capture, and corrected-gap cue
2-20	Coding	Clarify contract; state approach and invariant; implement; test one boundary and close
20-22	Reset 1	Release code context; breathe; restate the design contract; ask first clarification
22-40	System design	Set requirements and scale; draw flow; name bottleneck, failure, trade-off, metric
40-42	Reset 2	Release architecture assumptions; retrieve the selected story cue; reopen listening
42-52	Behavioral	Answer with context, ownership, actions, result, learning, and evidence
52-58	Follow-up pivot	Respond to one changed constraint or probe without rewriting the whole answer
58-60	Capture	Write strongest skill, remaining risk, and one action before the real loop

COMPRESSED-PROMPT RULE

If a segment cannot reach its main decision inside the time box, shorten the prompt before the rehearsal. Do not create artificial speed by skipping the contract or evidence.

TRANSITION PROTOCOL

Close, clear, and reopen

The two-minute reset prevents a weak moment from becoming the next round's starting state. It is a controlled handoff, not a postmortem.

01
Close
Name what is complete and what you would verify with more time.

02
Clear
Release the prior artifact; one breath, posture reset, water if needed.

03
Contract
State the new segment's input, output, scope, and first uncertainty.

04
Clarify
Ask one useful opening question before importing any old assumption.

Carryover risk	Reset sentence	Evidence of recovery
A coding edge case was missed	That round is closed. For this design prompt, I will first define users, guarantees, and scale.	The design answer opens with its own contract rather than an apology
A design assumption changed late	The prior assumption belongs to that prompt. For this story, I will use only facts from the selected event.	The behavioral answer does not borrow invented scale or ownership
A prior answer felt weak	I have one note for later. The next contract starts now.	First clarification arrives without re-litigating the old answer

Illustrative transition evidence

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Reset	What I released	First new contract / clarification
Coding -> design	Noted the missed duplicate test for later; closed editor and released pointer state.	For notifications, does acceptance mean stored safely or delivered to every channel?
Design -> behavioral	Parked the unresolved provider capability; did not borrow fictional traffic for the story.	I will use the actual rollback event and distinguish my decision from team execution.

WORKED LOOP SCORE

See recovery evidence without averaging away risk

These fictional observations follow the plan on the earlier page. Every score contains a reason; a missing boundary stays visible even when the rest of the segment is strong.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Segment	Opening contract	Decision quality	Boundary / failure	Communication / recovery	Close
Coding	2: output and empty case at 00:50.	2: invariant before loop.	1: duplicate test prompted.	2: repair explained without hiding it.	2: bound and remaining check named.
Design	2: acceptance versus delivery clarified.	2: durable state before workers.	1: provider timeout uncertain.	2: uncertainty labeled, not guessed.	2: age metric and next check.
Behavioral	2: scope and stakes in first 30 sec.	2: rollback choice and alternative.	2: failure and prevention factual.	2: personal role clear; no invented metric.	2: result and learning separated.
Follow-up	2: new tenant load restated.	2: fairness decision updated.	2: noisy-tenant containment.	2: unrelated guarantees preserved.	1: no final cost summary.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Transition	Score + evidence	Quote, timestamp, or observer evidence
Coding -> design	2	At 20:25, asks the new acceptance question instead of apologizing for the missed coding test.
Design -> behavioral	2	At 40:30, opens the incident story with actual scope and owned rollback decision; no design assumptions carried over.

EVIDENCE RULE

Do not average away a missing contract or unsafe failure decision. Record the specific moment, then decide whether it is a remaining risk or normal performance noise.

WORKED RECOVERY EXAMPLE

An imperfect moment does not have to spread

The purpose of the final rehearsal is not a flawless sequence. It is evidence that the learner can notice, reset, and restore the next decision order.

Moment	Carryover risk	Reset used	Evidence after reset
Coding closes without the duplicate-input test	Learner keeps replaying the miss and enters design silently	Writes one later-note, closes the editor, breathes, states design users and guarantees	First design clarification appears within 25 seconds
Design bottleneck is identified late	Learner overexplains the miss inside the behavioral story	Labels the assumption for debrief, retrieves the selected story cue only	Story opens with factual context and owned decision
Behavioral result lacks one metric	Learner invents precision during follow-up	States what was measured and what was not; asks which result layer matters	Follow-up stays accurate and distinguishes fact from estimate

USEFUL SIGNAL

Recovery

The next segment regains its contract, evidence, and decision order without needing a rescue.

RISK SIGNAL

Masking

The learner rushes, apologizes repeatedly, invents evidence, or silently imports the prior answer.

Completed recovery note

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Imperfect moment	Reset action	Evidence that the next segment recovered
Missed duplicate-input test in coding; urge to explain it again during design.	Wrote one factual note, closed editor, took water, and asked the new contract question.	Design opened within 25 seconds with acceptance versus delivery; the prior error did not consume the next segment.

DEBRIEF AND TAPER

Keep three strengths and one remaining risk

Use the final evidence to reduce work. A taper protects retrieval, sleep, and decision clarity; it does not reopen every weak topic.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Final evidence	Quote, artifact, or observed moment	What to carry forward
Stable strength 1	Coding invariant stated before implementation in the last two comparable runs.	Keep one invariant checkpoint; do not add a second framework.
Stable strength 2	Both resets establish the next contract within 30 seconds without rescue.	Use close, clear, contract, clarify between rounds.
Stable strength 3	Incident story separates personal judgment, team execution, measured result, and learning.	Use three factual story labels rather than memorize full answers.
One remaining risk	Timeout-after-send answer still jumps from retry to guaranteed no duplicates.	Rehearse one honest boundary sentence and ask what external guarantee exists.

Time horizon	Do	Avoid
48-24 hours	One short retrieval pass; confirm logistics; normal sleep and meals	Novel hard problems, whole-plan rewrite, long late-night mock
24-2 hours	Review cue cards and one risk sentence; stop when retrieval is clean	Adding stories, memorizing scripts, comparing yourself to others
Last 2 hours	Protect energy, equipment, water, quiet, and arrival time	Score analysis, forum browsing, or another full rehearsal

FINAL ACTION

Rehearse one exact sentence or decision once more only if it addresses the remaining risk. Stop when it appears unaided; do not rehearse until it becomes a brittle script.

RUNBOOK DESIGN

Build a one-page operating sheet

The runbook should answer what to do before, between, and after rounds without competing for attention during the interview.

Section	Include	Exclude
Logistics	Timezone, date, format, links, contact, backup connection, accommodation	Passwords, sensitive identity data, unnecessary account details
Evidence cues	Target-role sentence, compact story index, technical decision cues, two reminders	Full scripts, model answers, leaked prompts, confidential notes
Reset ritual	One fact, one question, one adjustment; breath, posture, water	A full postmortem while the loop continues
Recovery path	Contact method, interruption sentence, reconnect order, backup device	Improvised promises or unauthorized recording
Questions	Two role- and team-relevant questions with one follow-up each	Questions already answered in the interview or public role brief

Carry only useful evidence

- [ ] One target-role and level sentence.
- [ ] Three story labels with outcome and ownership cue, not full scripts.
- [ ] Coding contract / invariant / test cue and design requirement / failure / trade-off cue.
- [ ] Two questions and the two personal reminders most likely to improve decisions.

ETHICAL BOUNDARY

Use your own notes and public or authorized preparation material. Never carry leaked questions, confidential employer information, or recordings made without consent.

PRE-LOOP CHECKLIST

Remove avoidable friction by horizon

Confirm the items when they can still be fixed. The final ten minutes should be a calm readiness check, not a technology project.

24 hours before

- [ ] Date, timezone, expected duration, round format, and interviewers when supplied.
- [ ] Meeting links, calendar access, contact path, and any requested documents.
- [ ] Accommodation or accessibility needs are confirmed through the proper contact.
- [ ] Primary and backup location, internet path, and transport or arrival buffer.
- [ ] Sleep, meal, medication, and other personal energy needs are planned safely.

60 minutes before

- [ ] Power, charger, audio, microphone, camera, browser, editor, and permitted tools work.
- [ ] Primary link opens; backup connection and backup device are available.
- [ ] Quiet space, lighting, background, temperature, water, and interruption plan are ready.
- [ ] Runbook, blank paper, and allowed notes are visible but do not obstruct the screen.

10 minutes before

- [ ] Close notifications, unrelated tabs, messaging apps, downloads, and system updates.
- [ ] Use the restroom, reset posture, breathe normally, and take water.
- [ ] Open the correct link and join at the expected time; do not start a new practice problem.

INTERRUPTION SENTENCE

I am experiencing [brief factual issue]. I am switching to [backup] now. If we disconnect, may I rejoin through the same link or contact [name / channel]?

BETWEEN ROUNDS

Use the three-minute reset

Capture only what helps the next round. Do not grade the entire interview while the loop is still running.

Minute	Action	Write only
0-1	Release	One factual moment from the prior round; no verdict
1-2	Recover	One breath cycle, posture, water, and any immediate logistics need
2-3	Reopen	One question and one adjustment for the next round's contract

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Round	One fact	One question	One adjustment
After coding	Invariant was clear; one duplicate test was prompted.	What does acceptance promise in the next design?	Start from the new contract, not the old score.
After design	Provider timeout guarantee remained uncertain.	Which owned decision best answers the next story question?	Use actual incident facts; do not invent a metric.
After behavioral	Rollback alternative and prevention were explicit.	Which part of the role has the most ambiguous ownership?	Ask a role-relevant question and listen before adding examples.

Situation	Recovery script
Prompt is unclear	Before I choose an approach, may I confirm [input / goal / constraint]?
You are stuck	I will restate the contract, test the smallest case, and name the correct baseline.
Connection fails	Reconnect using the backup path, then send the prepared factual message.
Prior round felt weak	I have one note for later. I will start the next contract without carrying a verdict.

COMPLETED RUNBOOK EXAMPLE

Read a compact operating sheet that supports listening

This illustrative record models the level of detail to keep. Copy your real private logistics into your own notes; do not treat example times, events, or contacts as yours.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Runbook field	Illustrative final record
Schedule / timezone / links	Fictional practice: 09:00-10:00 IST (UTC+05:30). In a real runbook, copy the actual date, zone, and approved link from the invite; test the link privately.
Contact / interruption path	Use the recruiter contact from the invite. If disconnected: reconnect once, then send a brief factual update through the agreed channel. Do not put credentials here.
Backup connection / device	Charged laptop and phone hotspot tested before the loop; charger connected. Confirm the backup is allowed and available in the interview location.
Target role + two evidence cues	Senior backend: reliable service ownership; cross-team API migration. Cues: rollback judgment and backwards-compatible adoption.
Three story labels	Rollback: bounded risk; API migration: influence; review mechanism: repeatable team leverage. Use only truthful events from your own work.
Technical reset cues	Coding: contract -> invariant -> boundary. Design: guarantee -> state -> failure -> trade-off. When stuck, shrink the case and name the uncertainty.
Two questions to ask	Which decisions should this engineer own in the first six months? What reliability trade-off currently causes the team the most recurring work?

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Final summary	Illustrative evidence
Three stable strengths	Invariant before code; reset to each new contract; factual incident ownership with a clear alternative.
One remaining risk	External-send timeout handling still tempts an unsupported exactly-once claim.
One next action before the loop	Rehearse the provider-boundary sentence once, verify logistics, then stop adding content and protect normal rest.

FINISH WEEK 12

Stop when the system is ready

The capstone is complete when the rehearsal proves usable skills, the remaining risk is bounded, and the runbook removes avoidable day-of decisions.

Roadmap task	Required artifact	Completion proof
Complete the full-loop rehearsal	Selected prompts, 60-minute run sheet, segment evidence, transition notes	Three stable strengths, one remaining risk, and one exact next action
Finish the interview-day runbook	One-page schedule, logistics, evidence cues, reset ritual, backup path, questions	The sheet can be used in under one minute without reading answer scripts

Common mistakes

+ Using full-length prompts that cannot reach the intended decision in the compressed clock.
+ Treating transitions as dead time instead of a recovery skill.
+ Turning one imperfect segment into a verdict about the whole loop.
+ Adding new content during the taper or rehearsing until language becomes brittle.
+ Building a long runbook that competes with listening and live reasoning.

YOUR NEXT ACTION

Confirm the runbook once, rehearse the one remaining risk only to the stop condition, then protect sleep, energy, logistics, and honest decision-making.

Completion check

- [ ] Four representative segments and two transitions were rehearsed.
- [ ] Each score cites an observable moment.
- [ ] Three strengths, one risk, and one action are recorded.
- [ ] The logistics and backup path are confirmed.
- [ ] The three-minute reset and ethical boundaries are visible.

APPLY THE METHOD TO YOUR OWN EVIDENCE

Build your own one-page private runbook: verified logistics, backup path, three truthful story labels, two technical cues, two questions, three evidenced strengths, one risk, and one action. Keep scripts and credentials out.